

CODE OF ETHICS AND PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT

1. Purpose

This Code establishes the ethical principles and professional standards expected of all members, staff, volunteers, interns, affiliates, and partners of GIFON. It ensures integrity, trust, and accountability in the conduct of geospatial-related activities.

2. Scope

Applies to:

- Board of Trustees and Management
- Staff (permanent or temporary)
- Members and Affiliates
- Volunteers and Interns
- Consultants and Contractors
- Partners and Collaborators

3. Core Ethical Principles



1. Integrity

Act honestly, transparently, and consistently in all engagements.

2. Accountability

Accept responsibility for decisions, actions, and their consequences.

3. Professionalism

Uphold the highest standards of discipline, skill, and commitment in all geospatial-related work.

4. Respect for Rights and Diversity

Promote fairness, equality, inclusion, and non-discrimination.

5. Confidentiality and Data Protection

Respect sensitive information, intellectual property, and data privacy laws.

6. Public Interest and National Development

Prioritize the societal value and national relevance of geospatial activities.

4. Professional Conduct Guidelines

A. In the Workplace

- Maintain respectful and non-discriminatory work environments.

- Avoid harassment, intimidation, or abuse of power.
- Report conflicts of interest and avoid favouritisms.
- Protect Foundation assets and resources from misuse.

B. In Research and Data Handling

- Ensure accuracy, transparency, and reproducibility in data collection and analysis.
- Do not manipulate, distort, or falsify geospatial data.
- Cite sources and respect intellectual property.
- Uphold ethical standards in the use of AI, drones, and surveillance tools.

C. In Public Representation

- Represent GIFON in a dignified and informed manner.
- Avoid unauthorized media statements or public misrepresentation.
- Dress and act professionally in all public and official capacities.

D. In Partnerships and Collaboration

- Engage with integrity, mutual respect, and cultural sensitivity.

- Honor contracts, MoUs, and partnership terms.
- Avoid actions that could damage GIFON's reputation or relationships.

5. Conflict of Interest

- Disclose any personal, financial, or organizational interest that may conflict with GIFON's objectives.
- Avoid decisions or actions that could result in personal gain at the expense of the Foundation's interests.
- Refrain from soliciting or accepting gifts, favors, or bribes from partners, vendors, or stakeholders.

6. Use of Information and Technology

- Do not misuse access to confidential data or proprietary systems.
- Avoid unauthorized disclosure of internal records or datasets.
- Use communication tools (email, social media, digital platforms) responsibly and ethically.

7. Environmental and Social Responsibility

- Promote sustainable geospatial practices.

- Avoid causing harm to the environment, communities, or ecosystems in the course of geospatial activities.
- Consider the long-term societal impact of technologies and data being deployed.

8. Breach of Ethics and Reporting

- Violations of this Code should be reported confidentially to the Ethics & Compliance Committee.
- Whistleblowers shall be protected from retaliation.
- Investigations will be handled discreetly, fairly, and impartially.
- Sanctions for breach may include warnings, suspension, expulsion, legal action, or disqualification from GIFON activities.

9. Compliance

- All persons bound by this Code shall sign a declaration of compliance upon onboarding or partnership.
- Periodic ethics training shall be conducted for all staff and members.
- Compliance audits may be carried out by an internal or independent Ethics Officer.

10. Review and Amendments

This Code shall be reviewed biennially or as needed to reflect evolving ethical standards, legal requirements, and best practices in the geospatial intelligence sector.

Declaration

By signing this document or accepting engagement with GIFON, you agree to abide by this Code of Ethics and uphold the values and responsibilities it embodies.